NORTHBRIDGE FC

Annual Financial Report 2024/25

For the year ended 30 June 2025

Bristol, England

Premier League

Community • Ambition • Excellence

1. Executive Summary

Northbridge Football Club is a historic Premier League club based in Bristol, England. Following a period of decline, the Club is pursuing a disciplined return to the European elite under the ownership of Meridian Sports Group, a sports-focused investment group.

The 2024/25 financial year was characterized by healthy revenue growth, continued sporting progress and significant long-term investment. Revenue increased from £188.0 million in 2023/24 to £204.0 million in 2024/25, an increase of £16.0 million or 8.5%. Commercial income was the principal contributor to this growth.

Northbridge finished seventh in the Premier League and qualified for European competition. The sporting result produced a moderate positive financial effect through additional football income, exposure and commercial opportunities.

At the same time, the Club began a three-year redevelopment of its historic approximately 50,000-seat stadium. The project is focused on hospitality and commercial improvements while preserving the ground's historic character and core identity. Significant capital expenditure and associated financing costs contributed to a £5.0 million net loss for the year.

Management considers the Club financially healthy, with moderate debt and a healthy but managed cash position. The principal financial risks are broadcasting volatility, stadium redevelopment execution and player wage inflation. Management remains confident but disciplined about the Club's medium-term outlook.

Financial highlights

Metric	2023/24	2024/25	Movement
Total revenue	£188.0m	£204.0m	+£16.0m / +8.5%
Broadcasting	£68.0m	£72.0m	+£4.0m
Matchday	£36.0m	£40.0m	+£4.0m
Commercial	£63.0m	£72.0m	+£9.0m
Other operating income	£21.0m	£20.0m	-£1.0m
Net result	£8.0m loss	£5.0m loss	£3.0m improvement

2. Chairman's Statement

The 2024/25 season marked another step in Northbridge FC's long-term development. Our seventh-place Premier League finish and qualification for European football demonstrate progress on the pitch, while our financial performance shows that the Club can continue to invest without abandoning discipline.

Our three values — Community, Ambition and Excellence — remain central to the way we operate. We are proud to represent Bristol and its people, while serving a supporter community that now extends well beyond the city. Growth in international interest must strengthen, rather than dilute, the identity that makes Northbridge distinctive.

The commencement of the stadium redevelopment is a major milestone. The project is deliberately focused on improving hospitality, premium facilities and commercial capability while retaining the character of our historic home. It is a long-term investment, and we recognize the importance of controlling costs, protecting matchday operations and delivering the project in phases.

Financially, the year produced a £5.0 million loss. This result reflects investment in the Club's football and infrastructure rather than a deterioration in the underlying business. Revenue growth was broad-based, with commercial income providing the strongest contribution. We enter the next phase with a healthy liquidity position and a clear commitment to sustainable growth.

3. Club Profile

Item	Northbridge FC
Location	Bristol, England
Competition	Premier League
History	More than 100 years
Historical position	Former domestic powerhouse
Historical honours	4–6 league titles; multiple domestic cups; at least one major European trophy
Current position	Ambitious upper-table club
2024/25 league finish	7th
Stadium	Historic stadium; approximately 50,000 capacity
Ownership	Meridian Sports Group
Ownership type	Private, sports-focused investment group
Core values	Community • Ambition • Excellence

Strategic priorities

- Sustainable revenue growth
- Complete the stadium redevelopment
- Maintain a competitive football squad
- Strengthen financial resilience

4. Revenue Performance

The Club's revenue model is deliberately diversified. Broadcasting remains a major financial pillar, but Northbridge is not structurally dependent on a single income stream. Commercial revenue was the largest contributor to year-over-year growth, reflecting stronger sponsorship performance and the Club's expanding international commercial profile.

Revenue category	2023/24	2024/25	Change	2024/25 share
Broadcasting	£68.0m	£72.0m	+£4.0m	35.3%
Matchday	£36.0m	£40.0m	+£4.0m	19.6%
Commercial	£63.0m	£72.0m	+£9.0m	35.3%
Other operating income	£21.0m	£20.0m	-£1.0m	9.8%
Total	£188.0m	£204.0m	+£16.0m	100.0%

Broadcasting

Broadcasting income increased by £4.0 million to £72.0 million. The increase reflects Premier League distributions, performance-related distributions and European football-related broadcasting income. Broadcasting represents approximately 35.3% of total revenue, supporting the Club's assessment of moderate rather than high dependence.

Matchday

Matchday income increased by £4.0 million to £40.0 million. Growth was supported by ticketing and season-ticket activity alongside premium seating, hospitality, food and beverage and matchday experiences. The redevelopment project is intended to increase revenue per supporter rather than materially expand the stadium's capacity.

Commercial

Commercial income increased by £9.0 million to £72.0 million and was the principal contributor to total revenue growth. The Club's sponsorship portfolio includes an international primary shirt sponsor, secondary sponsors and official partners, alongside retail, licensing, international commercial activity and non-matchday commercial income.

Other operating income

Other operating income of £20.0 million includes European competition-related income and other football-related operating receipts. The category is intentionally separated from recurring broadcasting, matchday and commercial revenue and does not include player-trading gains.

5. Commercial Performance

Northbridge's commercial strategy combines strong Bristol roots with a growing international presence. The Club's objective is to broaden its supporter and commercial base without weakening its local identity.

Primary sponsorship

During 2024/25, Northbridge entered a five-year primary shirt sponsorship agreement with a fictional major global financial-services brand. The agreement provides a guaranteed base payment of £10.0 million per year, with additional performance-related bonuses linked to sporting and commercial milestones.

Primary sponsorship terms	2024/25 position
Industry	Financial services
Market position	Major global brand
Term	5 years
Guaranteed annual payment	£10.0m
Guaranteed contract value	£50.0m
Variable consideration	Performance bonuses
Bonus basis	Sporting + commercial milestones

The Club's sponsorship strategy is based on a portfolio model. This reduces concentration risk while allowing Northbridge to pursue larger international partnerships. Sponsorship concentration remains a secondary financial risk because the primary partner is commercially significant despite the wider portfolio.

Commercial revenue composition

Commercial stream	2024/25
Primary sponsorship — guaranteed base	£10.0m
Primary sponsorship — performance bonus	£2.0m
Secondary sponsorships	£15.0m
Official club partners	£8.0m
Retail & merchandising	£14.0m
Licensing	£5.0m
International commercial activity	£6.0m
Non-matchday events	£4.0m
Digital & membership income	£8.0m
Total commercial income	£72.0m

6. Football Operations & Player Trading

Northbridge maintains a balanced player-trading model. The Club develops young players, makes strategic first-team acquisitions and selectively sells players where sporting and financial considerations support a transfer.

2024/25 football strategy

Area	Position
Transfer approach	Competitive, disciplined investment
Player sales	Meaningful but selective
Academy	Important strategic pillar; above-average investment
First-team wages	Competitive and proportionate to revenue
Women's team	Significant strategic division

Player trading generated a meaningful financial contribution during the year. The Club does not, however, rely on player sales to fund normal operations. Profit on disposal of player registrations is presented separately from recurring operating revenue.

Illustrative player-trading summary

Measure	2024/25
Gross transfer acquisitions	£43.0m
Gross transfer disposals	£34.0m
Profit on disposal of player registrations	£8.0m
Net cash transfer investment	£9.0m

The above figures are presented for financial analysis and are distinct from the Club's £204.0 million operating revenue figure.

7. Operating Costs

Northbridge operates a substantial Premier League organization with meaningful expenditure across football, infrastructure, community and commercial functions. Operating costs are managed within the Club's balanced financial philosophy.

Operating cost category	2024/25
Player and staff wages	£88.0m
Stadium operations	£22.0m
Academy	£9.0m
Women's team	£7.0m
Administration	£17.0m
Commercial & marketing	£11.0m
Matchday operations	£9.0m
Other operating costs	£12.0m
Player-registration amortisation	£20.0m
Total operating costs	£195.0m

Player and staff wages of £88.0 million represent approximately 43.1% of revenue. This remains within the Club's stated moderate/healthy wage-to-revenue profile while supporting a competitive Premier League squad.

Profit and loss summary

Statement line	2023/24	2024/25
Revenue	£188.0m	£204.0m
Operating costs	£190.0m	£195.0m
Operating result	£(2.0)m	£9.0m
Profit on player disposals	£4.0m	£8.0m
Finance costs	£18.0m	£22.0m
Profit/(loss) before tax	£(16.0)m	£(5.0)m
Tax	—	—
Net result	£(16.0)m	£(5.0)m

The 2024/25 result therefore represents a £5.0 million net loss. The improvement from the prior year reflects stronger revenue and disciplined cost management, while finance costs remain elevated as the Club funds long-term investment.

8. Stadium Redevelopment

Northbridge has commenced a three-year phased redevelopment of its historic approximately 50,000-seat stadium. The project is designed to preserve the stadium's core character while materially improving its commercial capability.

Project characteristic	2024/25 position
Project duration	3 years
Reporting-year stage	Early construction
Capacity	Approximately 50,000
Primary focus	Hospitality and commercial transformation
Historic identity	Core character preserved
Operational approach	Stadium remains operational

The project includes expanded premium seating, executive facilities, hospitality areas, restaurants and lounges, conference/event capability and improved commercial/retail areas. The strategy is to increase the economic value of the existing ground rather than replace its historic identity.

Capital expenditure and financing

Stadium investment measure	2024/25
Capital expenditure incurred	£32.0m
External project financing drawn	£25.0m
Project cash contribution	£7.0m
Expected project duration	3 years

Capital expenditure is not treated as an operating expense in the profit and loss statement. The financing required for the redevelopment contributes to the Club's moderate debt position and higher finance costs.

9. Financial Position

Measure	2024/25 position
Debt profile	Moderate and manageable
Primary debt driver	Stadium redevelopment and long-term investment
Cash position	Healthy but managed
Financial philosophy	Balanced growth and sustainability
Overall risk profile	Moderate

The Club maintains sufficient liquidity for normal operations and planned investment without maintaining excessive idle cash reserves. Debt is considered manageable and is primarily linked to long-term capital investment rather than short-term operating losses.

Indicative cash-flow bridge

Cash-flow item	2024/25
Operating cash generated	£21.0m
Stadium capital expenditure	£(32.0)m
Net transfer investment	£(9.0)m
Financing inflows	£25.0m
Other investing/financing movements	£(3.0)m

Cash-flow item	2024/25
Net movement in cash	£2.0m

The cash-flow profile reflects the difference between accounting profitability and investment activity: the Club can report a modest net loss while continuing to generate operating cash and fund substantial capital expenditure.

10. Principal Financial Risks

Key risks

Broadcasting volatility. Changes in league position, European participation and broadcasting distributions could reduce a significant source of annual income.

Stadium redevelopment. Cost overruns, delays, financing costs or disruption to matchday operations could increase short- and medium-term financial pressure.

Player wage inflation. Maintaining a competitive squad may place upward pressure on wages. Management must keep wage growth aligned with sustainable revenue growth.

Secondary risks

Sponsorship concentration. The commercial portfolio is diversified, but the primary shirt sponsor remains financially significant.

Transfer-market volatility. Player valuations and the timing of disposals can affect football-related financial returns.

Relegation / loss of Premier League status. A significant change in sporting status would have material implications for broadcasting, commercial and matchday income.

Operational and cost inflation. Utilities, staffing, security, travel and infrastructure costs may rise faster than planned.

Commercial execution. International expansion and new partnerships may not produce expected returns if market conditions or supporter engagement change.

11. Management Outlook

Management remains confident but disciplined. Northbridge expects continued revenue growth while maintaining financial resilience and avoiding an uncontrolled increase in leverage or recurring expenditure.

The four financial priorities for the next planning period are sustainable revenue growth, completion of the stadium redevelopment, maintenance of a competitive football squad and strengthening financial resilience.

The Club expects later phases of the stadium redevelopment to improve premium hospitality and non-matchday commercial capacity. International commercial activity is also expected to grow as Northbridge expands its supporter base beyond Bristol.

Management recognizes that European qualification, broadcasting distributions, wage inflation and construction execution create uncertainty. The Club therefore intends to pursue growth through diversified income and disciplined investment rather than relying on a single source of financial upside.

12. Financial Analysis Appendix

Selected ratios

Ratio / metric	2024/25
Revenue growth	8.5%
Broadcasting / revenue	35.3%
Matchday / revenue	19.6%
Commercial / revenue	35.3%

Ratio / metric	2024/25
Other operating income / revenue	9.8%
Wages / revenue	43.1%
Net loss / revenue	2.5%

Analyst questions supported by this report

• How did Northbridge's revenue change between 2023/24 and 2024/25?

• Which revenue category contributed most to the £16.0m increase?

• What proportion of revenue came from broadcasting?

• How much did matchday revenue increase year over year?

• What was the guaranteed annual value of the primary shirt sponsorship?

• How much of commercial revenue came from sponsorship-related sources?

• What percentage of revenue was spent on player and staff wages?

• Why did the Club report a £5.0m net loss despite revenue growth?

• How much capital expenditure was incurred on the stadium redevelopment?

• What are the Club's three principal financial risks?

• How does the stadium redevelopment affect the Club's short-term and long-term finances?

• What are Northbridge's four stated financial priorities?

Document note

This report is a fictional Northbridge FC knowledge-base document created for the Dynamic Agentic System project. Its structure and terminology were informed by public football-club and football-governance reporting, including public filings and annual-report materials from Premier League organizations. No real club's financial figures, contractual terms or proprietary content have been reproduced.

The report is intentionally designed as a realistic RAG corpus: it contains related figures across sections, comparative periods, financial terminology, narrative context, risks, and analytical questions. Future Northbridge FC documents should treat the facts in this report as the baseline for internal consistency.